



Monash  
Association  
of Coding

# Introduction to Haskell

MAC X LEARN

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# Setup

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## Installing locally

- Install GHCup: [haskell.org/ghcup](https://haskell.org/ghcup)

- Run

```
ghcup install stack --set 3.7.1  
ghcup install hls --set 2.11.0.0
```

- Alternatively, use `ghcup tui` to install Stack and HLS interactively
- Clone [github.com/cherryblossom000/intro-to-haskell](https://github.com/cherryblossom000/intro-to-haskell)
- Run `stack test` (there will be test failures)

## Using CodeSandbox (online)

- Fork [codesandbox.io/p/devbox/mac-intro-to-haskell-workshop-g3ynvw](https://codesandbox.io/p/devbox/mac-intro-to-haskell-workshop-g3ynvw)
  - This is also linked in the GitHub repo
- Run `stack test` in a terminal (there will be test failures)

# What is Haskell?

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- **General-purpose** language
- Enforces **pure functional programming**
- **Statically typed**: no more `TypeErrorS`
- **Lazy**: only computes values when needed



# What is functional programming?

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- Declarative programming paradigm based on applying and composing functions
  - *Declarative* programming: specify what you **want** the program to do, rather than exactly **how** it should do it (imperative)
- Usually synonymous with '*pure* functional programming', which also tries to minimise side effects
- Code can be a lot shorter and easier to read/understand

# What is functional programming?

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## Imperative (C++)

```
vector<int> numbers{2, 4, 3, 1, 6, 10, 5};  
vector<int> result;  
for (int i = 0; i < numbers.size(); i++) {  
    int x = numbers[i] * 3;  
    if (x % 2 == 0) {  
        result.push_back(x);  
    }  
}
```

```
int sumOfResult = 0;  
for (int i = 0; i < result.size(); i++) {  
    sumOfResult += result[i];  
}
```

## Functional (Haskell)

```
numbers :: [Int]  
numbers = [2, 4, 3, 1, 6, 10, 5]
```

```
result :: [Int]  
result = filter even (map (*3) numbers)
```

```
sumOfResult :: Int  
sumOfResult = sum result
```

# What is functional programming?

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## Imperative (C++)

```
int result = 0;
int count = 0;
int a = 1;
int b = 1;
while (count < 10) {
    if (a % 2 != 0) {
        result += a;
        count++;
    }
    int tmp = a + b;
    a = b;
    b = tmp;
}
```

## Functional (Haskell)

```
fibs :: [Int]
fibs = 1 : 1 : zipWith (+) fibs (tail fibs)

result :: Int
result = sum (take 10 (filter odd fibs))
```

# What is functional programming?

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## Imperative (Python)

```
def partition(array, low, high):
    pivot = low
    for i in range(low + 1, high + 1):
        if array[i] ≤ array[low]:
            pivot += 1
            swap(array, i, pivot)
            swap(array, low, pivot)
    return pivot

def quicksort_aux(array, low, high):
    if low ≥ high: return
    pivot = partition(array, low, high)
    quicksort_aux(array, low, pivot - 1)
    quicksort_aux(array, pivot + 1, high)

def quicksort(array):
    quicksort_aux(array, 0, len(array) - 1)
```

## Functional (Haskell)

```
import Data.List (partition)

quicksort :: Ord a => [a] -> [a]
quicksort [] = []
quicksort (x:xs) = quicksort lt ++ [x] ++ quicksort gt
    where (lt, gt) = partition (<x) xs
```

# Why learn functional programming?

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- Easier to compose code together using functions as the main building block of programs
- Often leads to less code
  - Higher-order functions: `map`, `filter`, etc.
- Less error-prone code & bugs
  - `Maybe/Option` instead of null references
  - `for/while` loop bugs
- Easier to reason about code
  - Reduce mutable variables/state & side effects
- Helps you become a better programmer!



# Why learn functional programming?

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- Web development (e.g. React)
- Most modern programming languages have support FP or have FP features: JavaScript/TypeScript, Python, Rust, C++, Kotlin, even Java, ...
- FP languages: Haskell, OCaml, Scala, Elixir, F#, Elm, Clojure(Script) ...

# Hello, World!

```
-- Every Haskell program needs a 'main' defined
main :: IO ()
--      ^^^^^^^ type annotation (IO indicates a side effect)
main = putStrLn "Hello, world!"
--      ^^^^^^^ prints a string
-- no need for () to call a function
```

Run the program with `stack run`

# Haskell Syntax

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- Parentheses are used for grouping expressions together, not for calling functions
  - Python: `function1(arg1, function2(arg2), arg3)`
  - Haskell: `function1 arg1 (function2 arg2) arg3`
- Everything is an expression
- Run `stack ghci` to play around in a REPL

# Haskell Syntax

---

```
-- Comments start with two hyphens  
{- Multiline comments are  
like this -}
```

```
integer :: Int  
integer = 40 + 2
```

```
float :: Double  
float = 3.141592
```

```
string :: String  
string =  
    let  
        noun = "Haskell"  
        adjective = "awesome"  
    in noun ++ " is " ++ adjective
```

```
list :: [Int]  
list = [x, y, 3]  
    where  
        x = 1  
        y = 2
```

# Haskell Syntax

---

```
double :: Int → Int
double x = x * 2
```

```
add :: Int → Int → Int
add x y = x + y
```

```
listDescription :: [a] → String
listDescription [] = "list is empty"
listDescription _ = "list has stuff"
```

```
if1 :: Int → Int
if1 n = if n == 10 then 0 else n + 1
```

```
if2 :: Int → Int
if2 n
  | n == 10    = 1
  | otherwise = n + 1
```

```
if3 :: Int → Int
if3 10 = 0
if3 n  = n + 1
```

## Side Effects and Purity

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- Side effects are any changes to state outside of the function. For example:
  - Modifying global variables
  - Modifying an array that was passed into the function
  - Printing to console
  - Making network requests
- Pure functions have no side effects and always return the same output for the same input

## Side Effects and Purity

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- Pure functions are a lot easier to reason about due to **referential transparency**
  - This is the property that you can replace a function call with its output without changing the behaviour of the program
  - More generally, you can replace any expression with another expression that evaluates to the same value

## Side Effects and Purity

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```
def add_one(x: int) → int:  
    print(x)  
    return x + 1
```

```
import time  
def get_time() → float:  
    return time.time()
```

```
def double(xs: list[int]) →  
list[int]:  
    for i, x in enumerate(xs):  
        xs[i] = x * 2  
    return xs
```

```
counter = 0  
def inc_counter() → None:  
    counter += 1
```



# Tasks

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- `src/Part1.hs`
- Replace all error `"blah blah"`s with your own code
- Run `stack test --test-arguments 1` to test
- Run `stack ghci` for a REPL to help debug if needed
- Tip: Hoogle ([hoogle.haskell.org](http://hoogle.haskell.org)) can be used to search for functions by their name or even type (e.g. try searching for `Int → a → [a]`)

# Higher-Order Functions

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- In many languages such as Haskell, Python, and JavaScript, functions are first-class, meaning that they are can be treated like any other value
  - You can assign a function to a variable, use a function as an argument to another function, return a function from a function...
- Higher-order functions are functions that either accept a function as a parameter or return a function

# Higher-Order Functions

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- Functions can be composed together with `.` (like  $\circ$  in maths)
  - $(f \circ g)(x) = f(g(x))$
  - $(f \ . \ g) \ x = f \ (g \ x)$
  - e.g. `addOneThenDouble = (* 2) . (+ 1)`
- All functions in Haskell are **curried**
  - A function that takes e.g. 2 parameters actually takes in a single parameter and returns a new function that takes the second parameter
  - Helpful for reusing functions

# Higher-Order Functions

---

```
add :: Int → Int → Int  
add x y = x + y
```

```
five :: Int  
five = add 2 3
```

```
addOne :: Int → Int  
addOne = add 1
```

```
three :: Int  
three = addOne 2
```

```
def add(x: int) → Callable[[int], int]:  
    return lambda y: x + y
```

```
five = add(2)(3)
```

```
add_one = add(1)
```

```
three = add_one(2)
```

# Higher-Order Functions

---

```
-- Applies a function to all the elements of a list and
-- returns the results in a new list
map :: (a → b) → [a] → [b]
-- Only keeps elements in the list satisfying a predicate
filter :: (a → Bool) → [a] → [a]
-- Applies a function to each element of the list (from right to left)
-- and an accumulator value and returns the final accumulator value
-- AKA reduceRight in JavaScript
foldr :: (a → b → b) → b → [a] → b
-- Same as foldr but left to right
-- AKA reduce in JavaScript
foldl :: (b → a → b) → b → [a] → b
-- Anonymous functions in Haskell: \arg1 arg2 → arg1 + arg2
map    (* 2)           [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6] -- [2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12]
filter (\x → x `mod` 3 == 0) [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6] -- [3, 6]
```

# Higher-Order Functions

---

```
foldr (\x acc → x + acc) 0 [1..5] -- 15
-- could also be written as
foldr (+) 0 [1..5]
-- or
sum [1..5]
```

| x | acc         |
|---|-------------|
|   | 0           |
| 5 | 0 + 5 = 5   |
| 4 | 5 + 4 = 9   |
| 3 | 9 + 3 = 12  |
| 2 | 12 + 2 = 14 |
| 1 | 14 + 1 = 15 |

# Lists

---

- Lists in Haskell are linked lists

```
data [a] = [] | a : [a]
-- the : is an operator that can be used to
-- create a list given the head and tail
-- you can think of it like this:
data List a = Empty | Cons a (List a)
```

- `[1, 2, 3]` is just syntax sugar for `1 : 2 : 3 : []`
- `[1..4] = [1, 2, 3, 4]`
- `[1, 3..9] = [1, 3, 5, 7, 9]`
- `[1..]` is an infinite list `[1, 2, 3, ...]`

# Tasks

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- `src/Part2.hs`
- Replace all error `"blah blah"`s with your own code
- Run `stack test --test-arguments 2` to test
- Run `stack ghci` for a REPL to help debug if needed
- Tip: Hoogle ([hoogle.haskell.org](http://hoogle.haskell.org)) can be used to search for functions by their name or even type (e.g. try searching for `Int → a → [a]`)



# Data Types

---

```
data PairOfInts = PairOfInts Int Int
--      ^^^^^^^^^^^      ^^^^^^^^^^^
--      type              constructor
x :: PairOfInts
x = PairOfInts 1 2
```

```
data Pair a = Pair a a
-- 'a' is a type variable
y :: Pair String
y = Pair "abc" "def"
```

```
getFirst :: Pair a → a
getFirst (Pair x _) = x

getSecond :: Pair a → a
getSecond pair = case pair of
  Pair _ y → y
```

# Data Types

---

```
data Person = Person
  { name :: String
  , age  :: Int
  }
```

```
person1 :: Person
person1 = Person "Lauren" 19
```

```
person2 :: Person
person2 = Person
  { age = 19
  , name = "Lauren"
  }
```

```
getName1, getName2, getName3 :: Person → String
getName1 (Person n _) = n
getName2 Person{name = n} = n
getName3 person = name person
```

# Data Types

---

```
data Suit = Hearts
          | Diamonds
          | Clubs
          | Spades
```

```
suit :: Suit
suit = Hearts
```

```
message :: String
message = case suit of
  Hearts → "it's hearts!"
  _      → "something else"
```

```
displaySuit :: Suit → String
displaySuit Hearts    = "♥"
displaySuit Diamonds  = "♦"
displaySuit Clubs     = "♣"
displaySuit Spades    = "♠"
```

# Maybe

---

```
data Maybe a = Nothing | Just a
```

- Used instead of `null/nil/None`
- Example: getting a value for a key in a dictionary/hash map

```
lookup :: k → Map k v → Maybe v
```

- Nice way to handle functions that may fail rather than having to catch exceptions

# Recursive Data Types

---

```
data BinaryTree a
  = Leaf
  | Node (BinaryTree a) a (BinaryTree a)
```

```
data Expression
  = Integer Int
  | Add Expression Expression
  | Subtract Expression Expression
  | Multiply Expression Expression
  | Power Expression Expression
```

# Tasks

---

- `src/Part3.hs`
- Run `stack run` to run the calculator
- Replace all error `"blah blah"`s with your own code
- Run `stack test --test-arguments 3` to test
- Run `stack ghci` for a REPL to help debug if needed
- Tip: Hoogle ([hoogle.haskell.org](http://hoogle.haskell.org)) can be used to search for functions by their name or even type (e.g. try searching for `Int → a → [a]`)

## Learning More + Resources

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- Haskell Wiki: `wiki.haskell.org`
- Hoogle (Search engine for Haskell functions):  
`hoogle.haskell.org`
- Learn You a Haskell for Great Good (tutorial):  
`learnyouahaskell.github.io`

If you liked this, consider taking FIT2102 Programming paradigms!